Drama teacher and cover plan

Creative Arts · BUILD · Spring 2 Week 2 · Tuesday 2 March 2027 · P1

Lesson

Keep and change your character

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Year A · Explore · Theme Resilience & Change

Weekly outcome

Develop a character with voice and movement.

Today I can

I can use my chosen voice and move.

I can try one helpful change.

I can log what I kept and why.

Prepare

For three to four pupils: books or arts logs, pencils and yesterday's actual choice notes if available.

Three original scene lines read or displayed one at a time.

A clear seated or standing working space; no props or costumes needed.

A pupil can direct the adult, and no recording is required.

Keep today's trial and reason for next week's story sequence.

Cover route

Retrieve real prior choice notes or make a fresh two-pace trial dated today. Read the three original lines. Model a pause and turn cue, then support one real rehearsal, feedback, change and repeat. Keep evidence of performed or directed choices separately and accurately. Use a private listener if preferred.

Drama teaching sequence

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Arrival 3 minutes

Say: Yesterday our Keeper found the table had moved. Find your choice of voice and move. If you were away or the note is missing, make a fresh fast and slow test now; date it today. You do not need to pretend to remember.

Look for: Pupils retrieve actual prior choices or make a clearly dated fresh test. Participation and stop routes are confirmed.

Fallback: Read the role lines and offer fast or slow. Adult makes the selected trial while the pupil directs.

Check and response: Missing work is a fresh starting point, not a failure. Record the real date and support.

Starter 3 minutes

Say: Use a short warm-up at quiet talking level. One pupil says or directs a line; the other notices the pace, pause or small move. Then swap, or work privately with me.

Look for: Pupils recall a deliberate feature and give a neutral observation.

Fallback: Adult performs the pupil's confirmed choice and the pupil points to the feature they notice.

Check and response: An observation names a feature: I notice slow words or I notice an open hand. It need not judge the performer.

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I do 6 minutes

Say: I show the whole tiny scene once, with a pause before the last line. The Keeper looks to a new spot with one open hand. Now I rush the last line, then try the pause again. I keep the pause so the response is clear. Check: which part did I change?

Look for: Adult models a complete three-line scene, one revision and a reason. Pupils identify the pause as the changed feature.

Fallback: Read one line at a time. Use a hand cue for each turn. Let the pupil direct the pace of the last line.

Check and response: The pause before the final line changed. The story words stayed the same. A change is useful when it helps the intended scene.

We do 6 minutes

Say: I cue one turn at a time with an open hand. Use your chosen pace and move. Hinge: if both roles speak at once, what could help? Choose a hand cue or a louder voice. If anyone chooses louder, model the same sound level with a clear cue and try again.

Look for: Each role has a clear turn. Pupils choose a cue or pause to help turn-taking, not louder sound.

Fallback: Adult reads all lines while pupils direct turns with one, two and three fingers. Keep the same story order.

Check and response: A hand cue or pause helps us take turns. A louder voice does not tell us whose turn comes first. Rehearse the cue if turns are still unclear.

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Create 14 minutes

Say: Work in pairs, with an adult, or as a director. Use the three original lines or make your own short help line. First try the scene. A listener names one feature. Choose one change in pace, pause, movement or turn cue. Try again. Keep a brief note of the first try and final choice. No performance to the whole class is needed.

Look for: A real first try and a revised try show one intentional skill choice. The pupil can say or show what changed and why. Directed evidence is labelled accurately.

Fallback: Adult performs both versions under pupil direction. Ask: keep the pause or change it? Record the confirmed choice and reason.

Check and response: Example only: We added a pause before "I will try that" so the new plan was clear. A pupil may keep the first version if they can explain why it works.

Review 5 minutes

Say: Show one line or a short section to your chosen listener. The listener names a feature, and the maker explains one kept or changed choice. Reserve the last two minutes to return pencils and put logs in order.

Look for: Sharing is accessible and consensual. Feedback connects to a real feature, and the maker's choice is kept.

Fallback: The adult gives a neutral observation; pupil confirms by word, gesture or point. Sharing may be private.

Check and response: A useful reply is: I kept the slow line because it was clear. Both keeping and changing can be a reasoned decision.

Drama evidence and teaching checks

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Exit 3 minutes

Say: Complete today's real log. Record what you performed or directed, one change you tested and your reason. I can scribe and read it back. Pick one next step for next week's group story.

Look for: Dated arts-log entry distinguishes the actual trial, choice, reason and support. A next step points towards clear group turns.

Fallback: Pupil selects one feature and confirms a short adult note. Leave an honest gap if a part was not tried.

Check: Example only: I used slow words and an open hand. I added a pause to help my turn. Next time I will watch the cue.

Evidence and review

Keep a dated arts-log entry and a precise observation of a real trial. Record what the pupil performed or directed, the chosen feature, reason, feedback and support actually used. A photograph or recording is optional and follows local consent procedures. No supplied teacher model counts as pupil evidence.

Misconceptions

The best scene is the loudest - A clear pace and turn cue can help the scene at quiet talking level.

I must take every piece of feedback - Choose one helpful idea, test it and give your own reason.

The scene must be long - Three clear lines can show a change and a response.

Questions

foundation: Whose turn comes after the Keeper?

middle: Which pause or cue helped the scene?

higher: Why did you keep that voice and move when the plan changed?

Drama access and safety

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Safety

Clear a small working space. Keep both feet supported if seated. Use hands within each person's own space. No touching another performer or taking a prop from them. Sound is optional; stop on the agreed signal. Pupils can direct the adult to perform their chosen pace and movement. Record that as directed evidence, not a vocal or physical skill the pupil personally demonstrated.

Emotional and sensory access

Use the invented changed-table story. No personal story is needed. Offer seated movement, silent direction, a private adult audience and a pass on live peer performance. Voice and taps stay at talking level or below. Agree an open-hand stop signal and quiet return cue. No sudden sounds, contact, running, raised platforms, blindfolds or lifts.

Planned adaptations

Cognition And Learning: Pre-teach role, pace, pause and choice with a brief model. Show one instruction at a time. Offer two pace choices, rehearse once, then fade the prompt. Use a tiny plan with beginning, change and response.

Communication And Interaction: Give processing time. Accept pointing to a pace word, signing, a phrase, a sketch or exact words scribed by an adult. Read the record back for confirmation. Do not judge accent, eye contact or facial expression.

Semh: Keep the story fictional and low stakes. A pause, a change in method or a request for help can be the character's response. Let pupils choose the role, amount of performance and audience. Follow the agreed pause-and-return route.

Sensory And Physical: Offer seated hand movement and no sound. A pupil may direct an adult voice or movement. Keep each person in their own space; use no compulsory facial expression or posture. Ask before handling a pupil's work.

Eal: Plan in any language. Explain pace as how fast we speak or move. Accept first planning in a familiar language and check the intended meaning before adding English labels. The pupil may use a short English phrase or direct a partner.

The award and evidence

Both pathways work at Explore. The lesson contributes evidence towards the award; it does not confer the award. Optional next level work in GROW adds skills planning, reflection and sharing evidence for later review. It is not a separate requirement for Explore success.

Resilience can mean pausing, asking for help, changing a plan and trying again. It does not mean hiding feelings, tolerating harm or performing through pain.